



13 Ways to Reduce Patient No-Shows

SKED

There's no nice way to say it. No-shows are a bummer. They cost the practice revenue, they disrupt workflow, they are demotivating to staff, and worst of all, they negatively impact patient outcomes.

One missed appointment per week (valued at \$200) costs your clinic over \$10,000 in lost revenue annually. Cutting your missed appointments, even by a small amount, can have a significant impact on practice revenue.

Use this checklist to start scheduling smarter, not harder, to reduce the dreaded patient no-show.

- ☐ **Automated text reminders**
Often, appointments are missed simply because patients forgot them. Text messages have a 98% open rate, far exceeding the engagement rate of other communication channels.¹ Automated texts upon appointment booking, one week before the scheduled appointment, the day before, and the hour before ensure that appointments aren't forgotten.
- ☐ **Family scheduling**
Enable patients to easily schedule appointments for their entire family at once. Booking families in appointment blocks makes it easier for patients and helps the practice drive revenue with multi-person bookings.
- ☐ **Centralized appointment portal**
Provide patients a single location to view upcoming appointments and reference past appointments.
- ☐ **Self-serve rescheduling**
Create a policy that allows patients to reschedule their appointments with enough advance notice (commonly 5-7 days in advance). Include a link in your booking confirmation and a text message one week out that has a link to reschedule the appointment. A rescheduled appointment is much better for the practice than a missed one.
- ☐ **Two-way texting**
Allow patients to text with the clinic via a tool such as SKED to open up another proactive communication channel. Patients may be in a meeting or on the move and don't have time for a phone call, but a text makes it easy to get in touch.

Pro Tip: Leverage SKED for two-way texting to gain access to the "Smart Reply" feature. Smart Reply provides automated answers to common questions based on keywords, saving your staff time and wowing your patients with real-time responses, even after business hours.

- ☐ **Customize appointment reminders**
Use the patient's name and appointment time in reminders to capture the recipient's attention.
- ☐ **When missed appointments happen, don't lose them forever**
Automate patient no-show follow-ups via text message with links that make it easy to reschedule the missed appointment. Automated no-show campaigns take the pain out of patient reactivation.
- ☐ **Fill those last-minute gaps**
Got a gap in your schedule from a late-stage reschedule? Don't accept the revenue loss. Use SKED to mass text, email, or send push notifications to alert patients to last-minute appointment availability.
- ☐ **Calendar integrations**
When sending appointment confirmations, allow calendar integrations to make it easy for patients to add their chiropractic appointments to their Google and iCal apps.
- ☐ **Define a cancellation policy**
Include any fees that patients will incur for appointments canceled outside of the cancellation window, or for no-shows.
- ☐ **Identify high-risk no-show patients**
Create lists of patients who have historically no-showed and provide them with extra confirmations which may include follow up calls.
- ☐ **Reward good behavior**
For patients who maintain a perfect attendance record, consider a small reward for them. Some clinic-branded swag can make them feel special, and get your brand name worn around town.
- ☐ **Backup communications**
As a backup reminder, include email reminders in addition to text messages. If you use a patient app, leverage push notifications as another backup communication method. For less tech-savvy patients, consider using automated phone reminders.

Ditch No-Shows with SKED

Schedule Smarter, Smarter, not Harder

Chiropractors love SKED. The scheduling and communication software empowers your practice to automate appointment management, reduce no-shows, and simplify front desk tasks, all while delivering a seamless experience that patients love.

- ✓ Automated text, email, phone, and push notifications
- ✓ Customized appointment reminders
- ✓ Simplify workflow
- ✓ Easy mass communication

SKED



**Learn more about SKED, or schedule
a demonstration at sked.life**

References

1. <https://emarsys.com/learn/blog/sms-marketing-statistics/#:~:text=SMS%20messages%20have%20a%2098,ensures%20your%20message%20is%20seen>